

think independently on your feet. And therefore, in most cases, this thinking is different from others.

The other part is about perspective. Because of the diversity of experience, you are able to see the same issue from different angles.

Talking about the experience, if you have a candidate who has experience in the same industry for a very long time, the chances are that they haven't seen enough. Different perspectives from other industries, whether they are better or maybe worse, are important. Regardless, these candidates won't be aware of it. A candidate from different industry experiences or different types of roles has gathered so much variety that it helps them think innovatively. So, look for a variety of experiences.

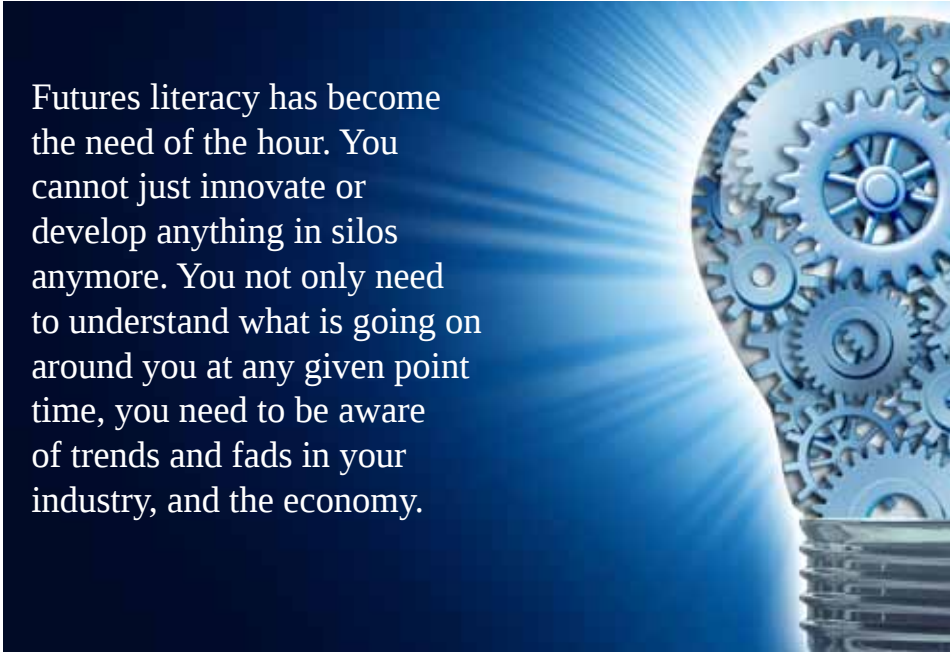
And of course, for the skills, you need someone who is not just a specialist in one thing but in many. It is important because innovation is often about finding new ways to do something, new combinations, and original combinations. Apparently, that is only possible when someone has a diverse set of skills; so go for it.

19. Entrepreneurs should be welcomed

Now, this one is interesting. I want to emphasize this point because I have often seen companies being skeptical of hiring entrepreneurs. They think that entrepreneurs may leave early or will be more distracted thinking about their next venture. Well, this is a very negative outlook on entrepreneurs.

First of all, entrepreneurs are and can be more loyal to you than an employee can. They understand it because they have had their employees, and they exactly know what you expect of them.

But more importantly, entrepreneurship teaches you so many different skills and techniques. They have gathered so much expertise through their



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entrepreneurial venture. So, once you have an entrepreneur in your innovation journey, you have multiple employees packed together in that one person. Therefore, if you get a chance to hire an entrepreneur for your innovation plans, jump on it; do not lose that opportunity. Without question, it is a very good bargain.

20. They are future-literate

Futures literacy has become the need of the hour. You cannot just innovate or develop anything in silos anymore. You not only need to understand what is going on around you at any given point in time, you need to be aware of trends and fads in your industry, neighbouring industries, and the economy. But you also have to be aware of what is coming and what might be coming in time to come.

That means people need to be aware of future scenarios. So, futures literacy is becoming more and more important. The complexity and volatility of the markets and economies force people to stay two steps ahead at any time. Being future-literate will help you do that, which is why you must look for this trait.

21. They love problems instead of solutions

People love what they create as a solution, product, service, or software program. And this is a trap. If you love your solutions, you are less likely to change when the problem changes and when the context changes. So, my strong advice to anyone is this: Not just for innovation, but a successful and sustainable business, always love the problem you are working on. Love the fact that you have an opportunity to work on that problem.

Your solutions may change over time as technology evolves and context changes. But if you are stuck with just the solution and are in love with your solution, it may soon become redundant.

Check out these attributes when hiring for innovation. Give them scenarios when they have to pivot and have to adapt to the problem. You need people who are okay with adapting to the problem and changing solutions. They are better suited than someone who refuses to change the solution despite seeing that everything else has changed.